
The First Sip

Your first AI film: a 15-second chai ad,
from three images to a finished video — on free credits

Generative AI Mastermind · Outskill · Hands-On Workbook

- 🕒 **Time:** ~90 minutes of hands-on work, spread over 2–3 days (so your free credits refresh)
- 🔧 **Requirements:** A free Krea account (krea.ai, no credit card) and the free CapCut app — that's it
- 💎 **Cost:** ₹0. Every step is designed to fit inside Krea's free 100 compute units per day
- ✓ **You will finish with:** 3 cinematic images, 3 video clips, and one edited 15-second ad you made yourself

1. How This Workbook Works

Instead of practising random prompts, you will produce **one complete piece of work**: a 15-second ad for the most relatable product on earth — a hot cup of chai on a rainy morning. You'll take the exact journey a professional AI Director takes: **storyboard → images → videos → edit**.

The concept is deliberately designed for beginners and free credits:

- **No faces.** Only hands, cups and kitchens — so you skip the hardest problem (character consistency) and the costliest mistakes.
- **Only 3 shots.** Few enough to finish on free credits; enough to learn establishing shots, close-ups and payoff shots.
- **AI loves this scene.** Steam, rain, glass and warm light are things image models render beautifully — your first results will look good, which keeps you motivated.

The three rules of free-credit production (follow these every single time)

✓ **Cheapest model first.** On Krea's model picker, choose a low-cost model (e.g. Seedream, ~6 units per image) for every test. Only re-run your final, perfected prompt on a premium model if you have units left.

✓ **One output at a time.** Set the number of generations to 1. Four variations of a wrong prompt is four times the waste.

✓ **Lowest resolution while testing.** 1K for images, 720p and 5 seconds for video. Upgrade only when the prompt is right.

⚠ Krea's free plan gives ~100 compute units per day (refreshing daily) with limited model access — and free-tier outputs don't carry commercial rights. This workbook is for practice; for client work you'd need a paid tier.

2. Step 0 — Setup (10 minutes)

- ☐ Create a free account at **krea.ai** (no credit card needed).
- ☐ Open the **Image** tool. Find two things before generating anything: the **model picker** (where you'll select a cheap model) and your **compute-unit counter** (so you always know what's left today).
- ☐ Open the **Video** tool once, just to see where it lives. Note which video models your free tier offers — availability is limited on free plans.

- ☐ Create a folder on your computer called **first-sip** with two subfolders: **images** and **clips**. Download everything you generate into these — out-of-order, like a real production.
- ☐ Install **CapCut** (free) on your phone or computer for the final edit.

3. The Concept & Storyboard

The ad: a rainy morning. Chai boils on the stove. It's poured, steaming, into a glass. Two hands wrap around the warm glass by the window. Text appears: *"Some mornings just need chai."*

Shot	Type	What the viewer sees
1	Establishing shot	A rain-streaked kitchen window at dawn; a steel saucepan of chai boiling on the stove, steam rising
2	Detail / close-up	Chai being poured from the saucepan through a strainer into a cutting-glass tumbler, steam curling up
3	Payoff shot	Two hands cupping the warm glass in front of the rainy window, cosy morning light

Notice the structure — **wide → close → emotional payoff** — the skeleton of almost every ad you've ever seen. Master it at 3 shots and you can scale it to 30.

4. Stage 1 — Generate the Three Images (Day 1, ~40–60 units)

Open Krea's Image tool, select a **cheap model**, set generations to **1** and resolution to **1K**. Remember the framework from the session: comma-separated keywords, most important element first, and always end with *"ultra-realistic, cinematic style"*.

Shot 1 — The rainy window (establishing)

Image prompt — copy as-is

✓ Prompt:

"Steel saucepan of milky chai boiling on a gas stove, steam rising, rain-streaked kitchen window behind it, early morning blue-grey light, cosy Indian kitchen, warm glow from the stove flame, side angle shot, shallow depth of field, ultra-realistic, cinematic style."

Check the output for: Is the saucepan the clear focal point? (It's first in the prompt — the priority rule.) Is there visible steam? Is the rain readable on the glass? If something is off, don't rewrite from scratch — **edit:**

Fix-it edit prompts (upload your image, then ask for one change)

✓ If too dark:

"Make the scene brighter with soft early-morning light, keep everything else the same."

✓ If no steam:

"Add thick visible steam rising from the saucepan."

✓ If the window is missing:

"Add a rain-streaked window in the background behind the stove."

Shot 2 — The pour (close-up)

Image prompt — copy as-is

✓ Prompt:

"Extreme close-up of hot chai being poured through a steel strainer into a cutting-glass tumbler, rich golden-brown liquid, thick steam curling upwards, droplets and splash frozen mid-air, 100mm lens, dark moody kitchen background, warm window light from the left, ultra-realistic, cinematic style."

What you're practising: the **100mm lens** keyword for tight close-ups, and lighting direction ("from the left"). If the glass looks wrong for your region, swap "cutting-glass tumbler" for "ceramic mug" or "kulhad clay cup".

Shot 3 — The hands (payoff)

Image prompt — copy as-is

✓ Prompt:

"Two hands gently cupping a steaming glass of chai, in front of a rain-streaked window, soft grey morning light, cosy sweater sleeves visible, steam rising past the glass, condensation droplets on the window, leading lines drawing the eye to the glass, low warm contrast, ultra-realistic, cinematic style."

⚠ **Hands are AI's weak spot.** Count the fingers. If they're wrong, regenerate on the cheap model (that's why we test cheap) or edit: *"Fix the hands so they look natural, keep everything else the same."* Keeping hands wrapped around the glass (fingers partly hidden) is a deliberate trick — it hides AI's most common mistake.

Continuity check before you move on

Look at your three images side by side. Same glass style in shots 2 and 3? Same kind of window and light in shots 1 and 3? If not, edit the odd one out — e.g.

"Change the cup to a cutting-glass tumbler to match this reference image"

(upload your shot 2 as the reference). Consistency across shots is what makes three images feel like **one film**.

Download all three finals into your **first-sip/images** folder. If you still have units left and one shot is clearly the hero, re-run that single perfected prompt once on a premium model (e.g. Nano Banana Pro) and compare the quality jump. Otherwise — stop. Your credits refresh tomorrow.

5. Stage 2 — Turn Images into Video (Days 2–3, ~60–90 units per day)

Now switch to Krea's **Video** tool. Three rules change here:

- **Image-to-video, never text-to-video.** Upload your Stage 1 image as the **start frame** — it anchors the look.
- **Natural language, full sentences.** Video prompts describe motion and timing, not comma-separated keywords.
- **720p, 5 seconds, one generation.** Video burns units fast — a single 5-second clip can cost 30–60 units, which is why each shot gets its own day on the free plan.

Clip 1 — from your Shot 1 image

Video prompt (upload Shot 1 as the start frame)

✓ Prompt:

"The chai in the saucepan bubbles gently and steam rises steadily. Rain runs down the window in the background. The camera slowly zooms in towards the boiling saucepan. The flame under the pan flickers softly. Calm, cosy early-morning mood."

What you're practising: the "camera zooms in, slow" movement (type it or use Krea/Kling's camera preset), and describing ambient motion (bubbling, rain, flicker) so the scene feels alive.

Clip 2 — from your Shot 2 image

Video prompt (upload Shot 2 as the start frame)

✓ Prompt:

"Hot chai pours through the strainer into the glass in slow motion. The liquid swirls as the glass fills. Thick steam curls upward. The camera holds still in a tight close-up. 3 seconds in, the pouring stops and the last drops fall into the glass."

What you're practising: slow motion, a **locked (still) camera** for detail shots, and a **timestamp** ("3 seconds in...") to control when an action happens. Models don't always obey timing precisely — if the pour never stops, regenerate without the timestamp.

Clip 3 — from your Shot 3 image

Video prompt (upload Shot 3 as the start frame)

✓ Prompt:

"The hands slowly lift the steaming glass of chai slightly, as if about to take a sip. Steam drifts upward past the window. Rain continues to streak down the glass behind. The camera slowly zooms out to reveal the cosy window scene. Soft, warm, peaceful mood."

What you're practising: "camera zooms out, slow" — the classic ending-shot move that pulls away to reveal context.

Optional bonus — the start + end frame transition

If your free units allow one more generation, try the session's most powerful technique. Upload your **Shot 2 image as the start frame** and your **Shot 3 image as the end frame**, and let the model build the bridge between them:

Video prompt (start frame: Shot 2 · end frame: Shot 3)

✓ Prompt:

"The freshly poured glass of chai is picked up and carried to the window. The scene transitions smoothly from the close-up of the pour to two hands cupping the glass in front of the rainy window. Steam rises throughout. Gentle handheld camera movement."

When a clip goes wrong (it will — that's the workflow)

✗ Motion happens in the wrong direction or wrong object moves → ✓ name positions explicitly: "the saucepan **on the left**", "pours **from above**".

✗ Too much chaotic motion → ✓ add "the camera holds still" and "slow, gentle movement" — calmer prompts make cleaner clips.

✗ The image morphs into something else → ✓ shorten the prompt; describe only ONE action per 5-second clip.

Pros go through many takes per shot. Two or three regenerations on a clip is normal, not failure.

Download every usable clip into **first-sip/clips** — including imperfect ones; you choose the best takes in the edit, like every real production.

6. Stage 3 — The Edit (CapCut, free, ~30 minutes)

☐ **Import** your three clips into a new CapCut project and place them in story order: window → pour → hands.

☐ **Trim** each clip to its best 3–4 seconds. Cut *on motion* (mid-pour, mid-zoom) — it feels smoother than cutting on stillness.

☐ **Add the tagline** as a text overlay on clip 3: *"Some mornings just need chai."* Simple white serif text, fading in for the last 2 seconds.

☐ **Add sound.** If your video model generated native audio, use it. Otherwise layer CapCut's free library: rain ambience under everything + one soft acoustic track. (Want a voiceover? ElevenLabs has a free tier.)

☐ **Export** at 1080p, 9:16 (vertical) for Instagram/WhatsApp or 16:9 for YouTube.

That's it. You have produced a complete ad — storyboarded, shot, directed and edited — without a camera, a studio, or a rupee spent.

7. Your Free-Credit Budget

A realistic plan for Krea's ~100 daily free units (costs vary by model and settings — treat these as estimates and watch your counter):

Day	Work	Est. units
Day 1	Shots 1–3 on a cheap image model (~6 units each), plus 4–6 edit/retry generations	~40–60
Day 2	Clips 1–2 at 720p / 5s (~30–60 units each, model-dependent) with one retry budgeted	~60–100
Day 3	Clip 3 plus the optional start→end frame transition, or premium re-runs of your hero image	~60–100

△ Free-tier video model access on Krea is limited and unit costs change; if a video model isn't available on your free plan, use the free trials on Kling (klingai.com) or Hailuo (hailuoai.video) for Stage 2 with the exact same prompts — they accept the same start-frame + natural-language inputs.

8. Make It Yours — Remix the Concept

The skeleton (establish → detail → payoff, on free credits, no faces) works for almost anything. Re-run the workbook once with your own twist — same prompts, swap the nouns:

Your version	Swap in the prompts
Filter coffee	"steel saucepan of chai" → "brass filter dripping decoction"; "cutting-glass tumbler" → "steel dabara tumbler"; pour becomes the classic metre-long stretch pour
Monsoon maggi	Boiling noodles in shot 1, the fork lift in shot 2, hands holding the bowl by the window in shot 3

Your version	Swap in the prompts
Morning workout	Alarm clock at 6 AM, shoes being laced in close-up, an open door to a misty street as payoff
Your product	Establish where it lives, a macro detail of it in action, hands holding the result — the universal product-ad formula

9. Completion Checklist

- ☐ 3 final images saved (window / pour / hands), consistent glass and lighting across shots
- ☐ Every image generated cheap-first, one output at a time, at 1K
- ☐ 3 video clips generated image-to-video at 720p / 5s, using zoom-in, locked camera, and zoom-out
- ☐ At least one clip regenerated after a failed take (congratulations — that's the real professional workflow)
- ☐ Final 15-second ad exported from CapCut with tagline and sound
- ☐ Shared with one person who had no idea you could do this last week

What you actually learned

Comma-separated image prompting with the priority rule · the "ultra-realistic, cinematic style" keyword · lens and lighting control · iterative editing instead of regenerating · image-to-video with start frames · camera movement and timestamps in natural language · start+end frame transitions · credit discipline · post-production assembly. That is the complete AI Director loop — everything else is the same loop with more shots.

See you in the next session. — Team Outskill